INCIDENT POSTMORTEM

Checkout errors after a configuration push

SEV-2, started 2026-09-03 14:02 UTC

Classification	Confidential

Document control

Type	Incident postmortem
Sources	S1 postmortem.yaml `aa93f3a98ea9`
Generator	flow-tower report
Classification	Confidential

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1 Summary

Severity	SEV-2
Started	2026-09-03 14:02 UTC
Time to detect	7 min
Time to mitigate	32 min
Time to resolve	2 h 18 min

2 Impact

- About one checkout in five failed for 39 minutes in the EU region.
- Customers saw a generic error page; no payment was taken twice.

3 Timeline

Time	Event
2026-09-03 14:02 UTC	Configuration change deployed to the EU region.
2026-09-03 14:09 UTC	Error-rate alert on checkout pages; on-call engineer paged.
2026-09-03 14:24 UTC	Payment client timeouts linked to the morning's configuration change.
2026-09-03 14:41 UTC	Configuration rolled back; error rate back to normal.
2026-09-03 16:20 UTC	Root cause confirmed; incident closed.

4 Root causes

Trigger	A configuration push lowered the payment client's connection pool from 200 to 20.

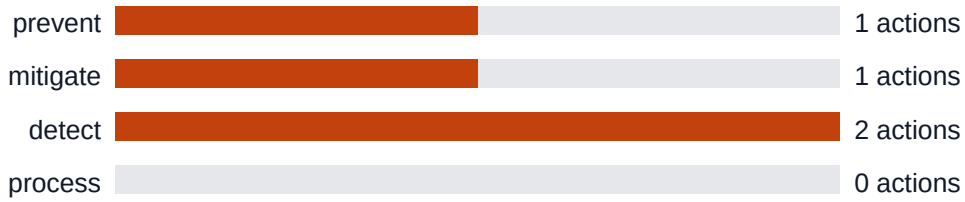
- The pool size field had no validation, so a typo passed review.
- The canary stage ran for two minutes, too short for checkout traffic to reach the new pool limit.

5 Actions

Id	Action	Kind	Owner	Due	Status
A-01	Validate pool size against a minimum in the config schema	prevent	Platform team	2026-09-17	done
A-02	Extend the canary stage to 15 minutes for payment services	detect	Release team	2026-09-24	open
A-03	Alert on payment client pool saturation	detect	SRE	2026-09-24	open

Id	Action	Kind	Owner	Due	Status
A-04	Add a one-click rollback to the configuration tool	mitigate	Platform team	2026-10-15	open

Actions by kind



6 Lessons

6.1 Well

- The error-rate alert fired within seven minutes.
- Rollback restored service at once.

6.2 Badly

- It took fifteen minutes to connect the errors to the configuration change.

6.3 Lucky

- The change was pushed outside the evening peak.

7 Appendix: sources

Id	Label	Location	SHA-256
S1	postmortem.yaml	samples/postmortem.yaml	`aa93f3a98ea9`